Whiteboard

User Guide

Comprehensive guide for users

The information in this guide relates to the standalone version of the whiteboard.
Some features may look or behave differently in the widget version.

Whiteboard Help Center
19.10.2026

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1. Introduction – About the Whiteboard

This guide walks you through your collaborative whiteboard tool. It provides a digital workspace where individuals or entire teams can create, structure and present content together – whether everyone is in the same room or working remotely.

Typical uses include workshops and brainstorming sessions, project and process planning, retrospectives, teaching and learning paths, and classic presentations. Your whiteboard runs directly in the browser, so no additional software needs to be installed.

1.1 Who is this manual for?

This manual is for everyone who wants to use NeoBoard actively – from signing in for the first time to advanced features such as real-time collaboration and presentation mode. Basic knowledge of using a web browser is assumed; no prior experience with other whiteboard tools is required.

1.2 How this manual is structured

The chapters follow the path you typically take when getting started with the whiteboard: from signing in, through the workspace and its tools, to collaboration and presenting. At the end you'll find tips for typical use cases and answers to frequently asked questions.

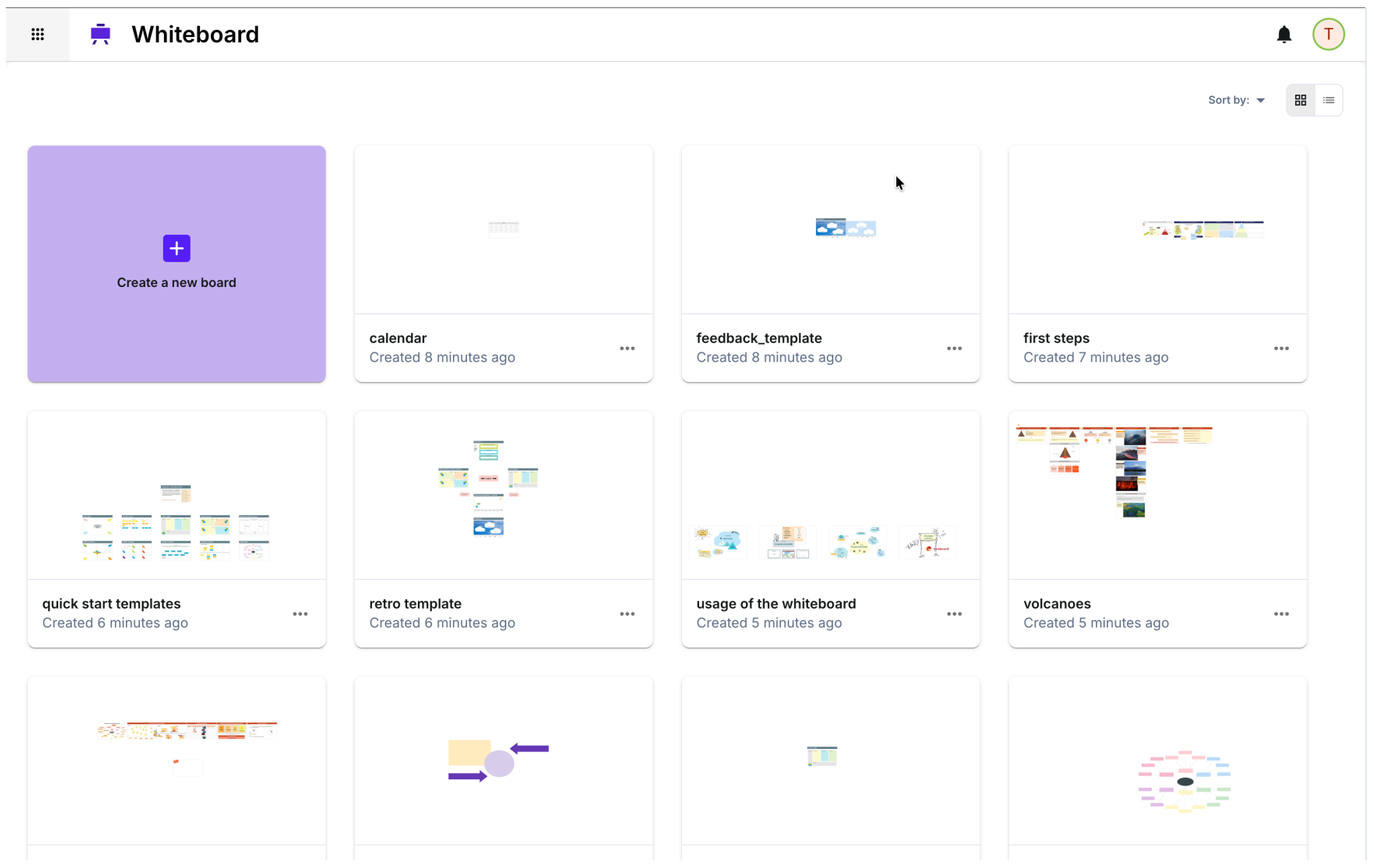
2. Getting Started

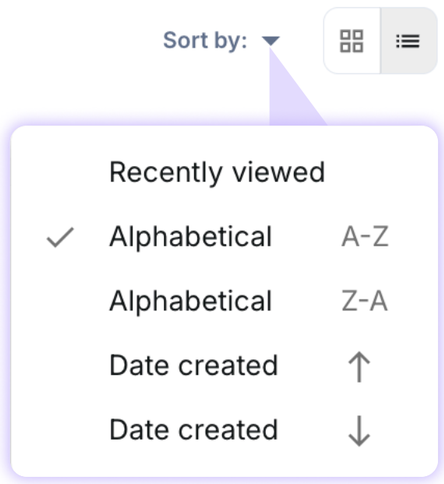
2.1 The dashboard

You reach the dashboard via the portal page or the main menu of your openDesk account.

At the top left you'll see the Whiteboard logo; at the top right, the notification icon [🔔] and your account icon [Ⓐ , see also chapter 3.1]. Below them is the overview of your boards.

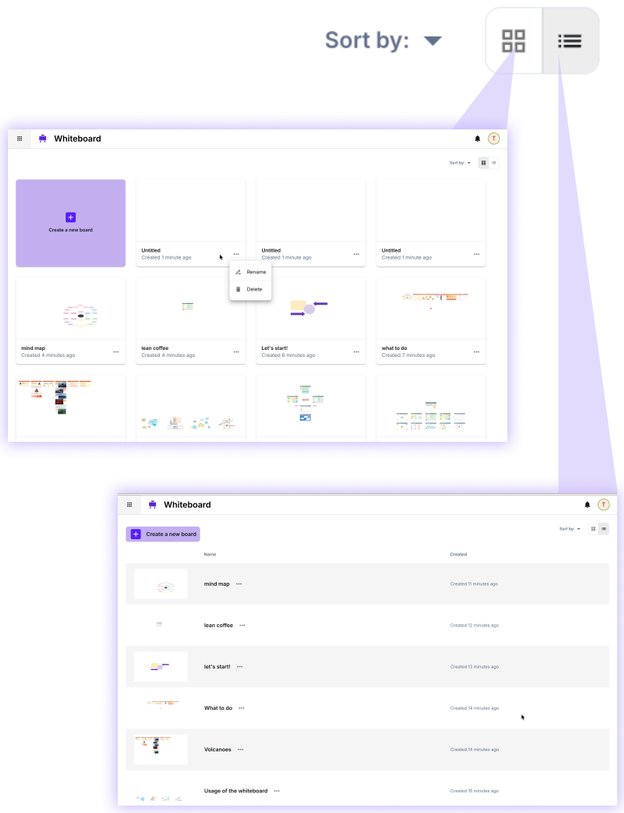
The portal icon [⠿] opens a menu that takes you to the portal page or to your other apps.





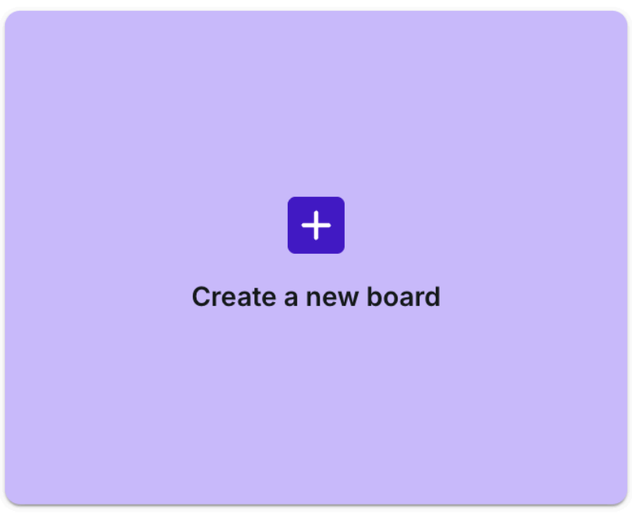
Sort by

Sets the order of the board tiles: recently viewed, alphabetical (A–Z or Z–A), or by creation date (ascending or descending).



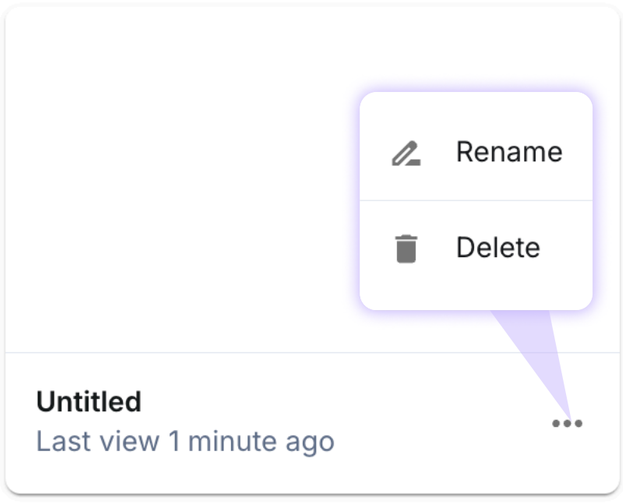
Grid view / list view

The two icons next to it [⊞] [≔] switch the board overview between tiles and a list.



Create new board

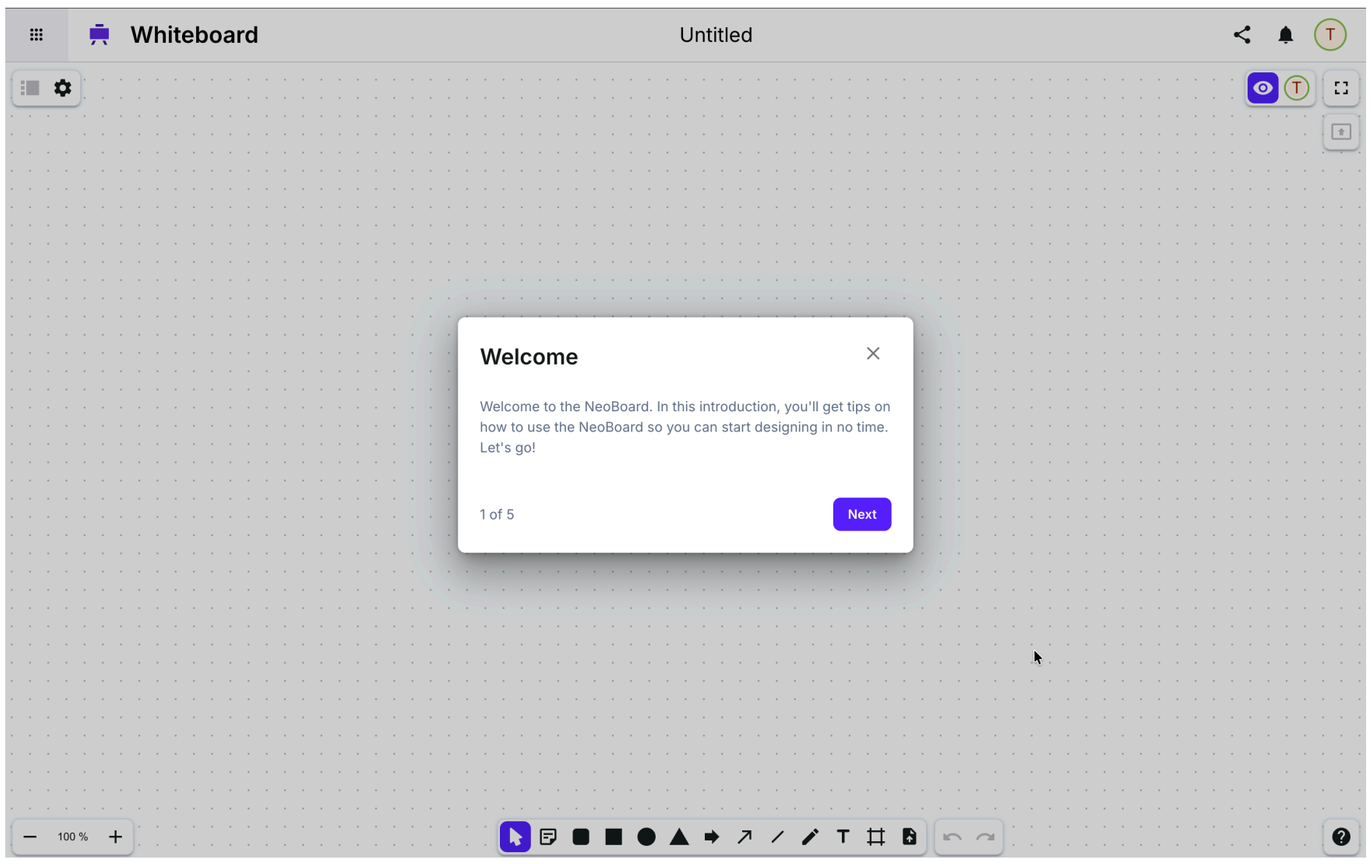
The large tile with the plus icon creates an empty board.



Existing boards

Each tile shows a thumbnail preview, the title and when the board was last edited. Click a tile to open the board. Use the [•••] icon on a tile to rename or delete the board. Caution: deleting cannot be undone.

2.2 The quick tour

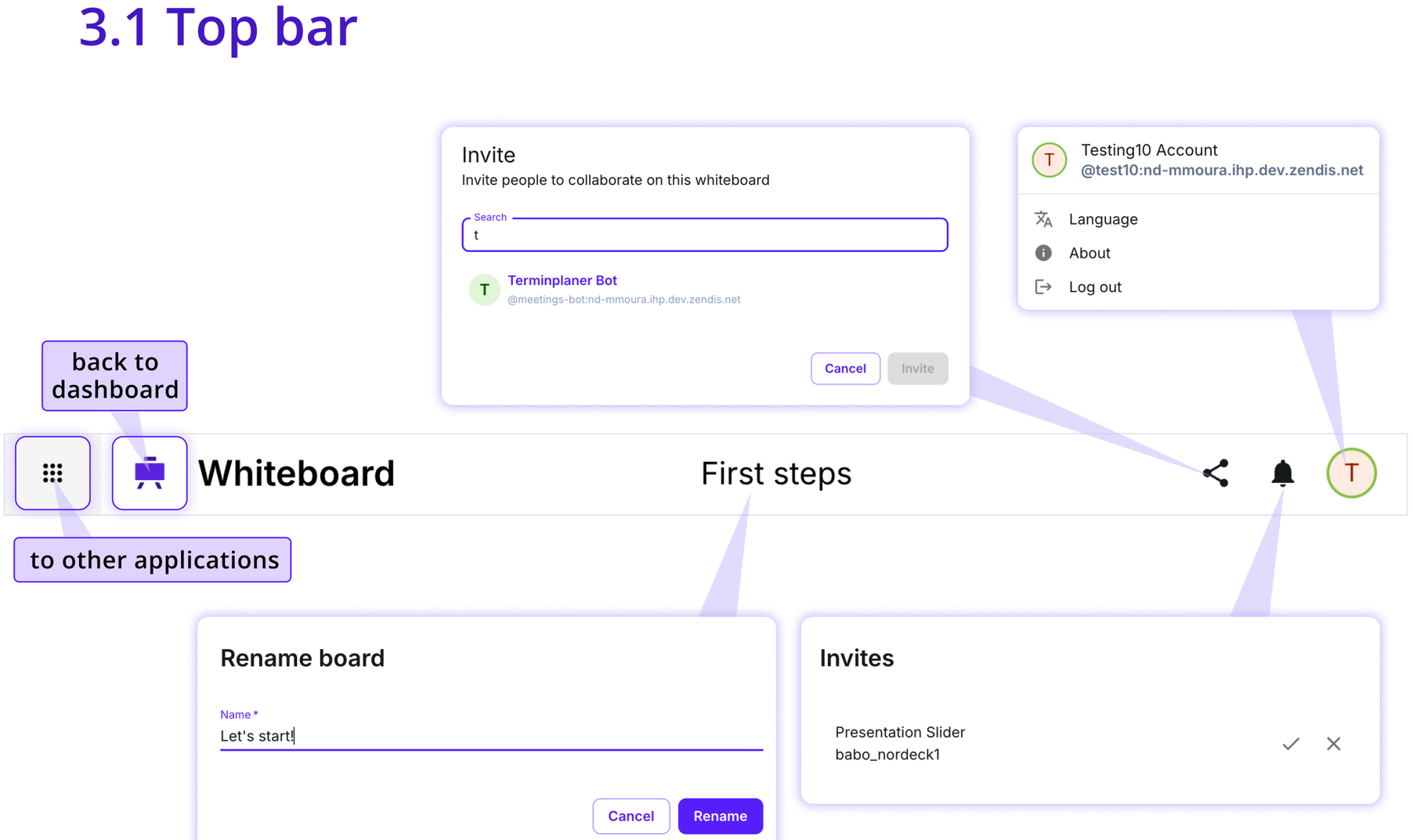


When you open a board for the first time, a short onboarding tour starts automatically: a series of pop-up windows explains the most important areas of the workspace one after another. Use the Next and Back buttons to move through the steps, or close the tour at any time with the [✕]. You can restart the tour later from the help center (see chapter 3.5).

3. The Workspace at a Glance

The workspace of an open board is divided into fixed areas that always stay in the same place, regardless of the zoom level.

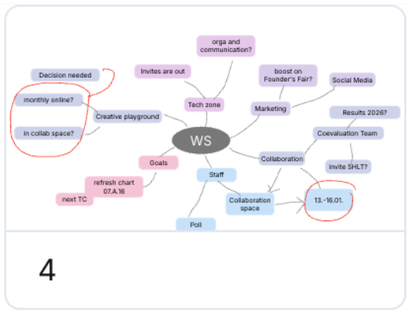
3.1 Top bar



On the left you'll find icons that take you to other apps and back to the dashboard overview. The board name is shown in the middle; double-click it to rename the board.

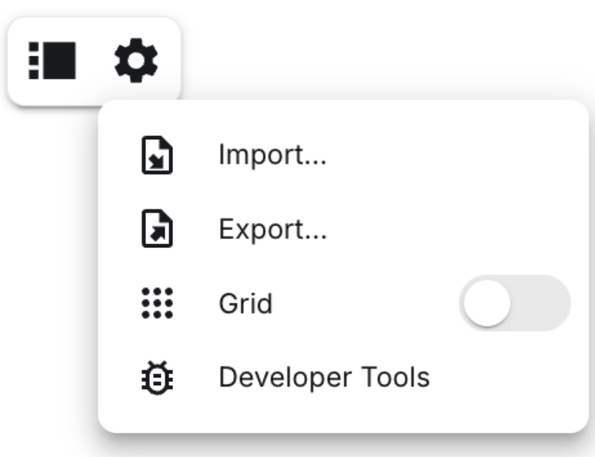
On the right you can invite people to the current board [ ], accept or decline invitations [ ], and open your account settings [◯ and your first letter or your image].

3.2 Frame overview and functions





The frame overview icon [▥] opens and closes the left sidebar, which shows the individual frames. Frames work like pages or slides in other programs and play an important role in structuring your board – see chapter 4.1.



The gear icon at the top left [⚙]opens the settings menu. It contains four entries:

Import

Adds existing content to the board that is currently open, for example templates, previously exported boards or some image formats.

Export

Saves the current board as a file, for example to keep it outside NeoBoard or to share it with people who don't have direct access to the board, or as a PDF for archiving or as an image. The import and export dialogs show which file formats are supported.

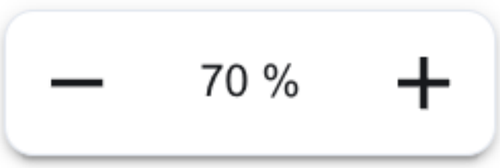
Grid

Turns the dot grid of the workspace on or off. The grid helps you align elements neatly without measuring; when it is off, elements can be placed freely.

Developer tools

Not needed for normal use of the board. They are only used for diagnostics and testing as part of technical development, so you can ignore them.

3.3 Zooming



The zoom controls at the bottom left let you zoom in [+] and out [−] and show the current zoom level as a percentage. A double click on the percentage resets to 100%.

In presentation mode the zoom controls are hidden so that the focus stays on the selected frame.

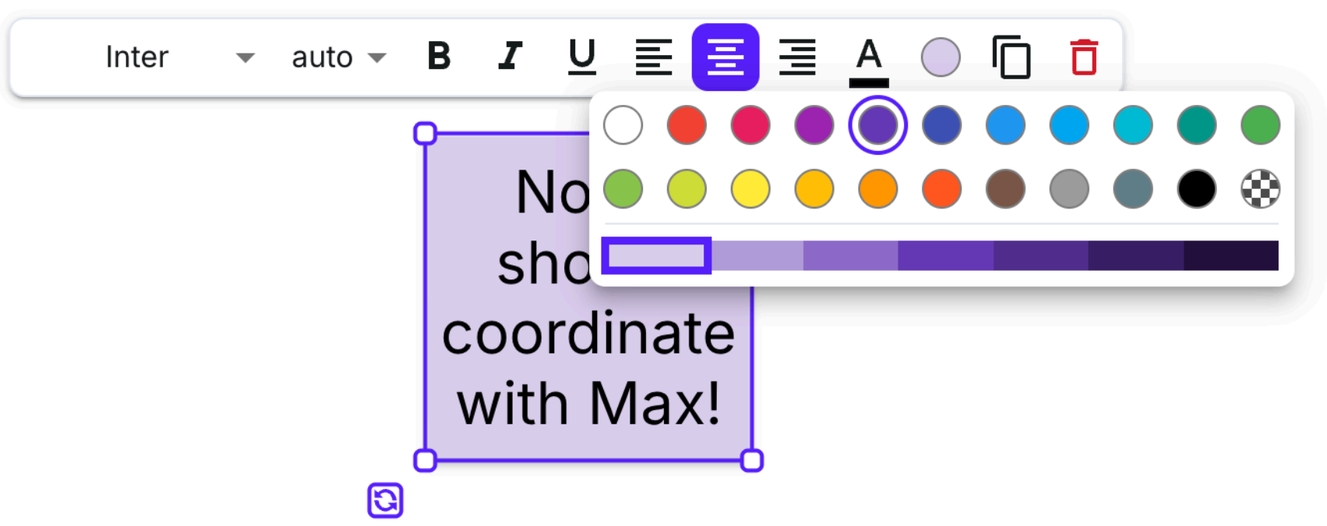
3.4 Toolbar

The toolbar at the bottom of the screen contains all design tools. Only one tool is active at a time; after you place an element, NeoBoard automatically switches back to Select (except for the pen tool).



Overview of the tools:

- **Select** – the default tool for selecting, moving and resizing elements.
- **Note** – places a sticky note you can type on directly.
- **Rounded rectangle / Rectangle / Ellipse / Triangle / Block arrow** – basic shapes you can write in.
- **Arrow / Line** – connecting elements, for example for processes or relationships between content. The thin arrow and the line can snap to the anchor points of other objects, so they can start in the middle of one box and lead to the corner of another.
- **Pen** – for freehand drawing.
- **Text** – places a plain text field without a surrounding shape (its background can be filled with a color, which turns it into a box).
- **Create frame** – adds a new frame, see chapter 4.1.
- **Upload image** – uploads an image file (including PDF) from your device to the board.
- **Undo / Redo** – reverses your last steps, or repeats them after you've undone them.

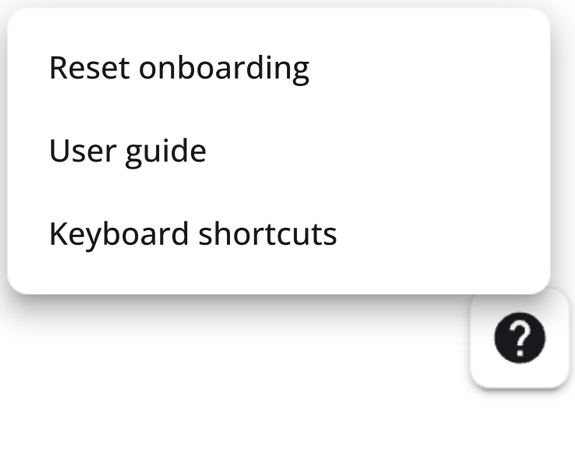


To draw a shape, select the tool and drag across the workspace while holding down the left mouse button. Use the rotation icon at the bottom left of a selected shape [↻] to rotate it. You can place text directly in shapes and notes or anywhere using the Text tool – in both cases, double-click the spot where you want to start typing.

When you create an element or select it later, a context menu tailored to that object appears. Use it to change properties such as colors and font settings, or to duplicate or delete the element.

Resize selected elements by dragging their corner points, and move them freely around the workspace.

3.5 Help center and support



The question mark icon [?] at the bottom right opens a board's help center. It contains these entries:

Reset tour

Restarts the quick tour from chapter 2.2 from the beginning.

Manual

You probably know this entry already: it brings you to this manual.

Shortcuts

Opens a window listing all available keyboard shortcuts.

Note: If you run into technical problems, contact your internal IT department or support team, see chapter 8.

3.6 Display and editing options



Participants

Everyone currently active on the board appears as a small circle with their initial next to the eye icon. Hover over a circle to see the full user name.

Cursors

Use the eye icon [👁] to show or hide the other collaborators' cursors.

Full screen

The full screen button at the top right [⛶] hides the top bar and enlarges the usable workspace. This is handy for presentations or on smaller screens.



Present

The button at the top right [⍐]starts the presentation. The board switches to a focused view of the selected frame, and your avatar shows the other collaborators that you are presenting. Use the arrows below it to move through the frames of your presentation. Click the same button again to end the presentation.

The lock icon [🔓] lets you prevent or allow editing of the board while it is being presented.

4. Designing and Organizing Content

You have several ways to keep your content clearly organized.

4.1 Frames

Frames are the central building blocks for structuring a board. They group related content and – much like slides or pages in other programs – can be arranged in a fixed order and later shown one after another in presentation mode.

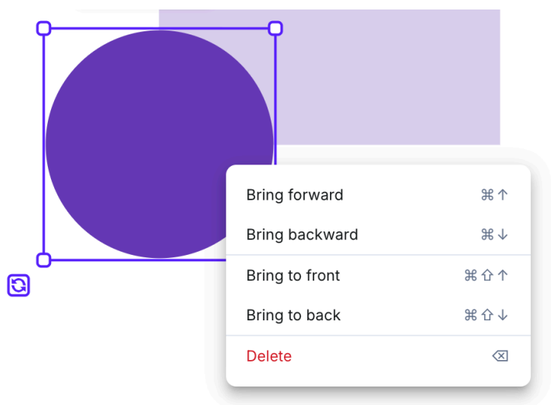
New frames are created in a default size that works well for presentations. You can change it by dragging the corner points of the active frame. To move a frame on the canvas, click inside the frame area and drag the active frame.

You guide people through a presentation by showing one frame at a time. The overview of your frames is in the sidebar, which you open with the frame overview icon at the top left [⫶■]. Change the order of the frames by drag and drop. You can lead the presentation from the sidebar view or from the presentation menu (see chapter 6).

4.2 Positioning and aligning

Elements can be moved freely around the workspace. When the grid is turned on (see chapter 3.2), elements snap more easily to an imaginary line as you move them. This is especially helpful for structured layouts such as Kanban boards or tables.

4.3 Layers

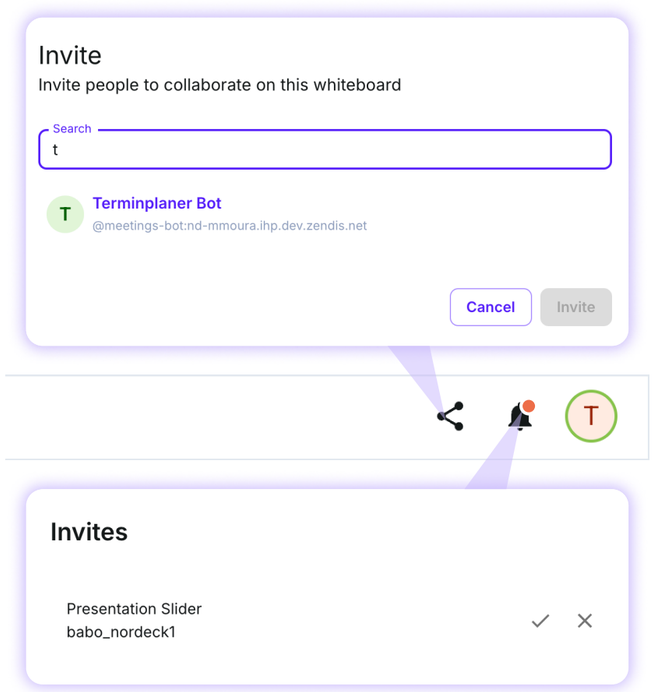


When elements overlap, you can change their stacking order: move an element one layer forward or backward, or bring it all the way to the front or send it to the back. You'll find the matching keyboard shortcuts in the help center [?].

5. Collaboration

The whiteboard is built for real-time collaboration. Several people can work on the same board at the same time and see each other's changes immediately. This is especially valuable alongside a video conference or a conference call, so ideas and agreements are captured visually and shared with everyone right away. Working on a shared board at different times also keeps all information in one place, accessible to everyone.

5.1 Inviting people and accepting invitations



The Invite button [ ] in the top bar opens a dialog with a search field. Enter the name or ID of the person you want to invite to edit the board with you, and confirm the invitation.

If the bell icon [ ] shows a circle with a number, you have pending invitations to other boards that you can accept or decline.

5.2 Seeing collaborators



The people currently on the board are shown by their avatars at the top right; hover over one to see the full user name.

Use the eye icon [ ] next to them to show or hide the other collaborators' cursors in your own view.

5.3 Working offline

If you keep working on an open board without an internet connection, your contributions become available to everyone as soon as you're back online. If you closed the board in the meantime, open it again so your contributions are shared with all users.

5.4 Sharing boards

5.4.1 Providing and receiving boards

If you don't want to or can't add people to your board directly, you can share it in other ways:

- Export the board and send your contact the NWB file. They need a Whiteboard account to open it.
- Export the board as a PDF.

If you receive an NWB file, create a new board and import the file (see chapter 3.2).

5.4.2 Reusing content

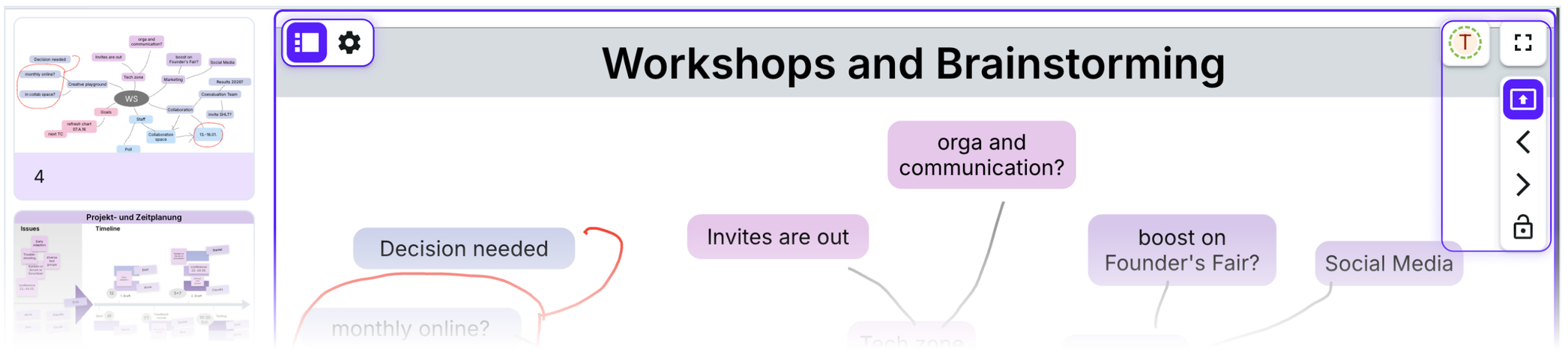
You can transfer elements of a board – individual elements or the entire board content – to another board by copying and pasting.

Template collection

A collection of board templates is available on GitHub:

- https://github.com/nordeck/neoboard-templates
- It contains useful templates for general use cases and is continuously being expanded. Click the file name and download the file to your computer. Then open a new board and import the template.
- You may want to set up a similar structure for collecting internal templates for yourself or your team.

6. Presenting



For talks and guided meetings, you can switch a board to presentation mode, which shows the frames one after another in focus. Here is an overview of the functions that matter for presenting:

6.1 Preparing a presentation

Have you organized your content in frames (see chapter 4.1) and are you ready to start your presentation or lead a workshop? Then this overview may help:

Who is present?



Shows who is currently on the board. Tip: hover over a circle to see the full user name.

Enlarge the workspace



Hides the top bar to give you more workspace.

Open the frame overview



Opens the sidebar with the frame overview so you can review or navigate the sections of your presentation. In presentation mode, the frame overview is hidden for other participants.

6.2 During the presentation

Start and end the presentation



Starts and ends presentation mode.

Switch frames



Go to the next or previous frame. Alternatively, use the frame previews in the sidebar.

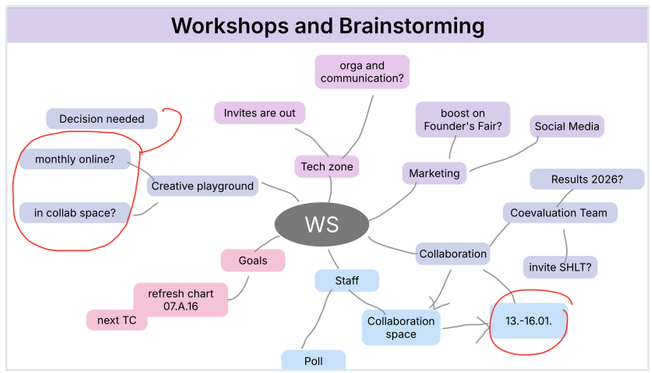
Allow or disable editing



Controls whether collaborators may also edit content during a running presentation, or whether the board is read-only for them while you present.

7. Tips and Use Cases

7.1 Workshops and brainstorming



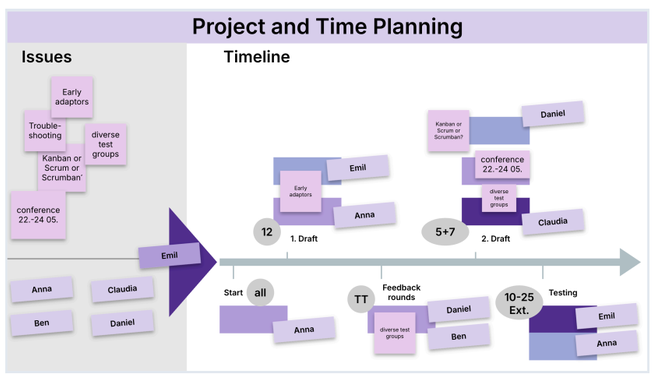
Use notes in different colors to cluster ideas by topic, then arrange them freely on the workspace into a mind map. A separate frame for each topic block keeps the board clear.

7.2 Meetings and presentations



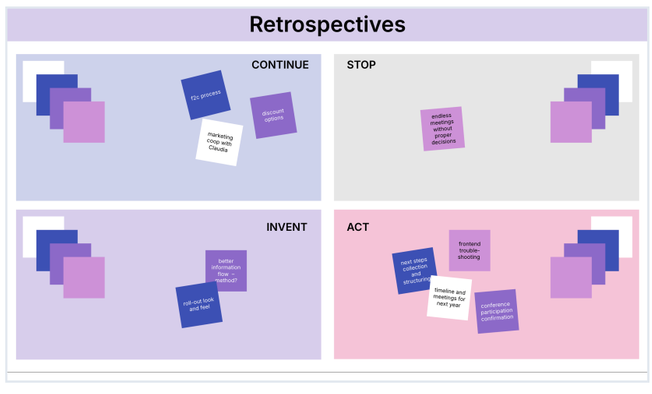
Prepare the board before the meeting, invite participants in good time, and use presentation mode during the meeting to guide everyone through the same frames. Enable collaborative editing deliberately once the group should add content themselves.

7.3 Project and schedule planning



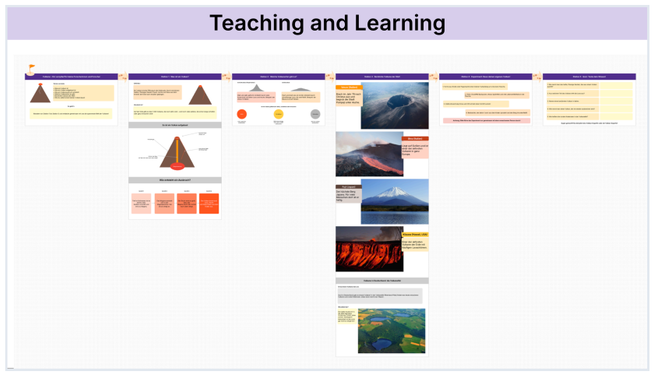
Kanban and timeline frames help you keep track of tasks, responsibilities and milestones. Use frames to keep different planning views (for example overview vs. detailed planning) neatly separated.

7.4 Retrospectives



For recurring formats such as “Start – Stop – Continue”, create a fixed frame that you duplicate for each retrospective (see chapter 4.1 on frames).

7.5 Teaching and learning paths



Build learning paths as a sequence of individual frames – one station per frame. Combine text, images and graphics, and end the path with a quiz or reflection frame.

8. FAQ and Troubleshooting

Question / problem	Solution
The zoom controls have suddenly disappeared.	Check whether you are in presentation mode. If so, exit it to get the zoom controls back.
The grid has suddenly disappeared.	Turn the grid on or off in the settings menu [⚙]. Also check whether the zoom is set to a low value: the grid shrinks as you zoom out and is no longer visible at low values (around 25 % or less, depending on your screen).
I can't work on a board together with others.	Check whether the people in question have been invited (see chapter 5.1) and whether collaborative editing is enabled during a running presentation (see chapter 6.2). Check your internet connection and reload the board.
My changes aren't saved, or others can't see them.	Check your internet connection and reload the board.
Who do I contact about technical problems?	Contact your internal IT department or support team. Include the version number, your browser and your URL. You can look up the version number in your account information / About (see 3.1), or – if the whiteboard is included in another program, e.g. a chat – in the Help Center / About the Whiteboard (see 3.5).